

August 2026

Dear Steven,

I've been selling homes in and around Walnut Creek long enough to know that end-unit townhomes on a hilltop cul-de-sac, directly across from the Acalanes Ridge Open Space, don't come along often. When I saw 1827 Lamplight Court come to market - with those soaring ceilings, walls of windows, and a floor plan that's one of the largest in Beacon Ridge - it stood out immediately. So when the listing came off the market after 47 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think the outcome matched what this home actually offers.

Forty-seven days is close to the threshold where buyer psychology starts to shift. It's not that the home wasn't right - the updated kitchen, the rebuilt balcony, the trail access, the light-filled layout - those are real assets that Walnut Creek buyers are genuinely looking for. What I suspect happened is that the marketing never fully built the case for the \$1,289,000 price point, particularly with an HOA at \$9,730 per month. That's a number that commands a narrative, and without one, buyers experience it as a cost rather than understanding what it actually covers. The home has a real story. The listing description touched on it, but the strategy didn't carry it across the finish line.

I've put together a packet for you that walks through the specific friction points I identified - the distribution gaps, the pricing framing, and the HOA positioning - along with a straightforward look at how I'd approach a relaunch differently. It's not a pitch deck. It's an honest analysis, and I think you'll find it useful whether you decide to move forward or not.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside - I understand, and I wish you the best with it. If you're not, I'd welcome a no-pressure conversation whenever the timing feels right. You can reach me directly at (925) 255-9727.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

1827 Lamplight Court

Walnut Creek, CA 94597

3.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,341 Sq Ft · Walnut Creek

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 1827 Lamplight Court

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Light-Filled Hilltop End-Unit with Trail Access and One of Beacon Ridge's Largest Floor Plans - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

1827 Lamplight Court has genuine, specific appeal for the Walnut Creek buyer who values light, space, and access to the outdoors. At 2,341 square feet, this is one of the largest configurations in the Beacon Ridge development - with separate living, dining, and family rooms, soaring ceilings, walls of windows, and a primary suite that qualifies as expansive by any measure. The rebuilt private balcony, the updated eat-in kitchen with skylights and custom cabinetry, and the direct connection to Acalanes Ridge Open Space and East Bay Regional Park trails are exactly what well-qualified buyers in this market are searching for. Add the Lafayette and Acalanes school district access, and this home checks boxes that are hard to find combined at this price point.

The listing history doesn't reflect those fundamentals. At 47 days on market without a sale, the property approached the point where buyer skepticism begins to compound. The \$9,730 monthly HOA, while likely reflecting meaningful amenities and community maintenance, was never framed as a value proposition in the marketing - it appeared as a line item rather than a membership. At \$551 per square foot, the home was priced at the lower end of the Walnut Creek range, which means the value story was there to tell. The marketing strategy just didn't tell it forcefully enough to convert interest into offers.

\$1,289,000

List Price

\$551/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

\$9,730/mo

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to do two things: reframe the HOA as a meaningful lifestyle value before buyers ever calculate it as a monthly burden, and build a visual and narrative case for the setting - the hilltop cul-de-sac position, the trail access, the light - that supports the asking price from first impression through offer.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: HOA Framing Failure - \$9,730/Month Was a Cost, Not a Membership

At \$9,730 per month, the HOA is the first number a buyer's lender will scrutinize and the first number a buyer will question. That's not a problem - it's a positioning challenge. Communities with HOA fees at this level typically provide exterior maintenance, insurance, landscaping, shared amenities, and structural reserves that would otherwise fall entirely to the individual homeowner. When marketing doesn't lead with what those dues actually cover in concrete terms, buyers fill the gap with doubt. The Beacon Ridge listing described the home's interior well, but it never made the case for the community structure that justifies the fee. The result: qualified buyers likely screened it out before scheduling a showing, treating \$9,730 as a red flag rather than a reflection of what comes with the property.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement allows us to control the narrative directly on the platform where most buyers are doing their initial research - leading with lifestyle context and community value before a buyer ever reaches the HOA line item.

Friction #2: The Hilltop Setting and Trail Access Were Mentioned, Not Sold

Being positioned at the end of a cul-de-sac, directly across from Acalanes Ridge Open Space with connections to East Bay Regional Park, is a meaningful premium for a specific and highly motivated buyer segment - outdoor enthusiasts, dog owners, and buyers who prioritize a sense of natural surroundings without sacrificing proximity to Walnut Creek. That buyer segment shops visually and emotionally before they'll commit to a showing. The listing description nodded at the setting, but standard MLS photography from the street and interior rooms can't convey what it feels like to step off a private balcony with filtered hill views or walk directly to open space trails. That experience - the one that justifies the price and the HOA - was never captured in a way that reaches buyers before they move on to the next result.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour gives buyers the aerial context to actually see the lot's position on the hilltop, the open space directly across the street, and the trail access - turning an abstract description into a visual that lands before the first showing.

Friction #3: Passive Distribution in a Selective Price Environment

At \$1,289,000 with a \$9,730 monthly HOA, the effective cost of ownership for this home is meaningful - and the buyer who can and will pay it is not browsing casually. They are doing research, comparing properties across Walnut Creek and Lafayette, and making deliberate decisions. Standard MLS distribution puts a home in front of whoever happens to be searching that day. It doesn't reach the SF or East Bay buyer who is three weeks from a serious move and hasn't yet focused their search specifically on Beacon Ridge or this hilltop corridor. With 47 days on market and no sale, the evidence suggests the right buyer was never actively found. A listing that waits for buyers to find it at this price point is working against itself.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns that reach buyers in San Francisco and the East Bay who are actively researching Walnut Creek and Lafayette before they've zeroed in on a specific property - putting this home in front of decision-makers, not just browsers.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	1827 Lamplight Ct.	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$551/sqft	\$650–\$730/sqft (standard updated range)
Lot / Setting	2,296 sqft lot, end-unit, hilltop cul-de-sac, across from open space	Typical Walnut Creek attached townhome lot, interior positions common
Architectural Character	Soaring ceilings, walls of windows, skylights, retro wet bar, plantation shutters	Standard townhome ceiling heights, conventional window placement
Premium Features	One of largest Beacon Ridge floor plans, rebuilt balcony, updated kitchen, trail access, Lafayette/Acalanes school district	Typical 3BR townhome configuration, standard finishes
HOA	\$9,730/mo	Walnut Creek HOA range varies widely; high-service communities \$500–\$1,500+/mo typical

The verdict: At \$551/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$650-\$730/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$551 per square foot, this home is priced well below the standard updated range for Walnut Creek, which means the value case was genuinely strong - the numbers support the listing price on a per-square-foot basis. The positioning challenge wasn't the price. It was that the marketing never built a clear, visible rationale for why this specific setting, floor plan, and community access justify the full cost of ownership including HOA. A relaunch strategy needs to lead with that case, not assume buyers will calculate their way to it.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Reframe the HOA as a Value Story Before Buyers Do the Math

The \$9,730 monthly HOA is the first number a serious buyer will put under a microscope. The strategy has to get there first, with a clear and honest accounting of what it covers - structural maintenance, exterior insurance, reserves, landscaping, and any community amenities - before a buyer's skepticism fills that space with doubt. BrightWork builds the HOA narrative directly into listing copy and portal placements so that buyers arrive at the number already understanding its context, not encountering it cold. That one shift can change how a qualified buyer reads every other line in the listing.

Pillar II - Give the Setting a Visual That Does the Work

A hilltop end-unit directly across from Acalanes Ridge Open Space is a location story that standard interior photography cannot tell. The rebuilt balcony, the filtered hill views, the trail access to East Bay Regional Park - these are the features that move a motivated outdoor buyer from online interest to a scheduled showing. BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot's hilltop position, the open space across the street, and the surrounding trail corridor in a way that makes the setting tangible for buyers researching from SF or Oakland before they've made a single call. The visual does the convincing before a showing has to.

Pillar III - Reach the Right Buyer Before They Find a Competing Property

The buyer who will pay \$1,289,000 plus a substantial HOA for a Beacon Ridge townhome is a specific person: probably relocating from San Francisco or the inner East Bay, values outdoor access and top-tier schools, and is conducting a deliberate, well-researched search. That buyer is unlikely to stumble onto this home through passive MLS distribution - they need to be reached before they commit to another property. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns put this home in front of buyers actively researching Walnut Creek and Lafayette, with enough visual and narrative context to earn a showing request from the right person at the right moment.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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